

Day 27 – IAM Ticket #005: Administrative Units and Delegated Administration

Scenario

Help Desk Ticket

The HR department requests that the HR IT team manage only HR users without receiving permissions to manage the entire tenant.

As an IAM administrator, you need to understand **Administrative Units (AUs)** and how they support delegated administration.

Note: If Administrative Units can't be created in your tenant, complete the review and document the limitation. Understanding the feature is still valuable for interviews.

Objective

- Review Administrative Units.
- Create an Administrative Unit (if available).
- Add users to the Administrative Unit.
- Review delegated administration.

Step 1 – Open Administrative Units

Go to:

Microsoft Entra Admin Center
→ Identity
→ Administrative units

Screenshot 1

- Administrative Units page

Home

Administrative units ...

[Learn more](#) [+ Add](#) [Delete](#) [Refresh](#) [Preview features](#) [Got feedback?](#)

[Add filters](#)

Name	Description	Restricted management	Membership type
☐ IAM-Lab-AU	Administrative Unit for IAM Lab	No	Assigned

Step 2 – Create an Administrative Unit

If the option is available:

Click:

+ New administrative unit

Create:

Field	Value
Name	HR-Administrative-Unit
Description	HR Department Administrative Unit

Click **Create**.

Screenshot 2

- New Administrative Unit

If your tenant does not allow creating Administrative Units, take a screenshot showing the unavailable option or the feature page.

Home

Administrative units

[Learn more](#)
[+ Add](#)
[Delete](#)
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[Preview features](#)
[Got feedback?](#)

[Add filters](#)

Name	Description	Restricted management	Membership type
☐ IAM-Lab-AU	Administrative Unit for IAM Lab	No	Assigned
☐ HR-Administrative-Unit	HR Department Administrative Unit	No	Assigned

Step 3 – Add Members

Open:

- HR-Administrative-Unit
- Users
- Add members

Add:

Emma Wilson

or another test user.

 Screenshot 3

- Administrative Unit Members

Home > HR-Administrative-Unit

HR-Administrative-Unit | Users

[Add member](#)
[Download users](#)
[Bulk operations](#)
[Refresh](#)
[Manage view](#)
[Remove member](#)
[Got feedback?](#)

[Add filter](#)

Manage

Properties

Users

Groups

Devices

Roles and administrators

Activity

Bulk operation results

Search users

Add filter

1 user found

☐	Display name ↑	User principal name ⓘ	User type	On-premises sy...	Identities	Company name	Creation type
☐	 Emma Wilson	emma.wilson@far...	 Member	No	farhamuntasiroutlook.onmicro		

Step 4 – Review Administrative Roles

Within the Administrative Unit, review:

Roles and administrators

Observe how roles can be scoped to only this Administrative Unit.

Screenshot 4

- Roles and Administrators

Home → HR-Administrative-Unit

HR-Administrative-Unit | Roles and administrators ...

Default Directory

Search

Refresh Preview features Got feedback?

To create custom roles, your organization needs Microsoft Entra ID Premium P1 or P2. Start a free trial. →

Administrative roles

Administrative roles are used for granting access for privileged actions in Microsoft Entra ID. We recommend using these built-in roles for delegating access to manage broad application configuration permissions without granting access to manage other parts of Microsoft Entra ID not related to application configuration. [Learn more.](#)

[Learn more about Microsoft Entra ID role-based access control](#)

Search by name or description Add filters

Role	Description	Privileged	↑↓	Ass...↑↓	Type
Attribute Assignment Administrator	Assign custom security attribute keys and values to supported Microsoft Entra objects.			0	Built-in
Attribute Assignment Reader	Read custom security attribute keys and values for supported Microsoft Entra objects.			0	Built-in
Authentication Administrator	Can access to view, set and reset authentication method information for any non-admin user.	PRIVILEGED		0	Built-in
Cloud Device Administrator	Limited access to manage devices in Microsoft Entra ID.	PRIVILEGED		0	Built-in
Entra SOC Identity Responder	Perform identity containment actions for SOC incident response, including disabling users, revoking sessions, and resetting passwords.	PRIVILEGED		0	Built-in
Groups Administrator	Members of this role can create/manage groups, create/manage groups settings like naming and expiration policies, and view groups activity and audit reports.			0	Built-in
Helpdesk Administrator	Can reset passwords for non-administrators and Helpdesk Administrators.	PRIVILEGED		1	Built-in
Hybrid Identity Administrator	Can manage AD to Microsoft Entra cloud provisioning, Microsoft Entra Connect, and federation settings.	PRIVILEGED		0	Built-in
License Administrator	Can manage product licenses on users and groups.			0	Built-in
Lifecycle Workflows Administrator	Create and manage all aspects of workflows and tasks associated with Lifecycle Workflows in Microsoft Entra ID.	PRIVILEGED		0	Built-in
Password Administrator	Can reset passwords for non-administrators and Password Administrators.	PRIVILEGED		0	Built-in
Printer Administrator	Can manage all aspects of printers and printer connectors.			0	Built-in
Privileged Authentication Administrator	Can access to view, set and reset authentication method information for any user (admin or non-admin).	PRIVILEGED		1	Built-in
SharePoint Administrator	Can manage all aspects of the SharePoint service.			0	Built-in
Teams Administrator	Can manage the Microsoft Teams service.			0	Built-in

Step 5 – Review Properties

Review:

- Name
- Description
- Members
- Scoped administration

Screenshot 5

- Administrative Unit Overview

Home

HR-Administrative-Unit | Properties ...

Default Directory

Search Save Discard

Manage

- Properties
- Users
- Groups
- Devices
- Roles and administrators

Activity

- Bulk operation results

Display name *
HR-Administrative-Unit ✓

Description
HR Department Administrative Unit

Membership type * ⓘ
Assigned ✓

Object ID
b57dabfe-19cc-4e49-964d-205ca93400de ⓘ

Restricted management administrative unit ⓘ
☒ Yes ☐ No

Step 6 – Verify Configuration

Confirm:

- Administrative Unit created (or documented as unavailable).
- Members reviewed or added.
- Scoped administration understood.

Screenshot 6

- Final Verification